Directory of economists

Maurice Allais 1911–2010

French economist Maurice Allais was one of the early pioneers of behavioral economics, studying the psychology of decision-making and in particular how rational our economic behavior is when faced with several choices. He studied mathematics in Paris, and worked as an engineer before being appointed professor of Economics at the École Nationale Supérieure des Mines. He won the Nobel Prize for Economics in 1988.

Jean Bodin (1530–1596)

The son of a French tailor, Jean Bodin was a lawyer, historian, and influential political thinker. He also published one of the earliest studies of inflation. Linking the amount of goods to the amount of money in circulation, he blamed the rise in prices across Europe on the influx of silver and gold from Spanish colonies in South America, in the 16th century, when the population was growing.

Ha-Joon Chang (1963–)

South Korean Ha-Joon Chang works at the University of Cambridge, UK, and is a leading critic of mainstream economics and development policies. In books such as *Kicking Away the Ladder*, *Bad Samaritans*, and *23 Things They Don't Tell You About Capitalism*, he questions the impact of free trade and globalization and argues for alternative types of intervention to tackle poverty.

Antoine Augustin Cournot (1801–1877)

Although born into a relatively poor family, Antoine Cournot studied mathematics and became a tutor, a secretary to one of Napoleon's generals, and a university lecturer. He pioneered the use of mathematics in economics, compared the industrial output and profits of monopolies and duopolies, and was the first to draw a supply-and-demand curve on a graph to illustrate the link between the demand for an item and its price.

Gérard Debreu (1921–2004)

French mathematician Gérard Debreu traveled to the US in 1948 and joined the influential Cowles Commission at the University of Chicago to apply mathematics to economic issues. In 1983 he won the Nobel Prize for his work on equilibrium—how markets can achieve an efficient, fair, and stable balance between the demands of consumers and firms and the supply of goods and services.

Richard Easterlin (1926–)

US professor of economics Richard Easterlin set out his "Easterlin paradox" in 1974. Looking at surveys of people's happiness in 19 countries over three decades, he found that reported happiness increased with income, as expected, but didn't vary greatly across countries, despite differences in national income. Rich countries weren't always the happiest. The US saw increases in GDP from